

component of Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL). Previously, it shipped out a standard kernel with all the patches that needed to be applied to make that kernel into Red Hat's version. For RHEL6, it switched to shipping an archive with which those patches pre-applied and details of the patches not explicitly listed.

Stevens explained that the change in distribution had come about because "...our competitors in the enterprise Linux market have changed their commercial approach from building and competing on their own customised Linux distributions, to one where they directly approach our customers offering to support RHEL."

WordPress hit by massive DDoS attack

The world's largest blogging host was recently subjected to a massive Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attack—believed to be the largest and most sustained attack it has seen in its six-year history. The first notification on the status page for Automattic Inc, the owner of wordpress.com, stated that, "The size of the attack is multiple gigabits per second and tens of millions of packets per second." Just over two hours later, Automattic reported that, "Our systems are back to normal. We'll continue to monitor them and post updates here, if needed."

WordPress, which runs about 18 million blogs on the platform, uses open source software for the design of blogs and other Web services.

Yocto, OpenEmbedded join forces

The Linux Foundation has announced that the Yocto Project, a Foundation workgroup announced in October 2010, is joining forces with the OpenEmbedded community, comprising developers of a cross-compile environment enabling the development of "...a complete Linux Distribution for embedded systems."

The intention is to make it easier to build embedded systems with Linux. Grant Likely, a member of the Linux Foundation technical advisory board, commented, "Linux is huge in the embedded market because it can be adapted for any application, but it isn't always easy to get started with a custom design."

Android copies Linux Code: Experts

According to Florian Mueller, campaign founder of NoSoftwarePatents—Android, one of the most successful open source projects, has copied more than 2.5 MB of code from 700 Linux kernel header files. The refurbished code also drops all source code comments and other source code elements and daringly claims that the extracted material does not constitute any 'copyrightable information'.

Although the Linux kernel is open source and freely available to developers, people who use and distribute it in derivative works must abide by strict licensing requirements.

Android, WP7 unhacked at Pwn2Own

At the 2011 Pwn2Own competition, which ran from March 9 to 11 this year, Android remained unhacked; however, it has to share the top honours with Windows Phone 7 which, too, was a tough nut for hackers to get into. However, rivals BlackBerry and Apple weren't lucky, as hackers were able

Asus developing a Chrome/Android OS netbook

Asus is fighting back to revive the once hot netbook market. According to reports appearing in the Taiwan media, it would be tying up with Intel to market a netbook running on the Android/Chrome OS in June.



There already are a slew of netbooks running Android, such as the Toshiba AC100. However, the company that created the market of netbooks, Asus, would surely look to do something noticeable on moving from Linux to a more sophisticated and complete OS like Android.

According to reports appearing in Digitimes, the \$200-\$250 netbook would ship somewhere around June and either run on Android 3.0 Honeycomb or Chrome OS. We have seen Honeycomb run on tablet PCs. It would be interesting to see how it is optimised to run on a keyboard-based gadget, if at all!

Chrome gets a new Logo

Google has given its Chrome browser a new logo—a design that drops the bubbly 3D look for one that is flatter and more geometric. The new design is no surprise: an all-blue version of the new logo recently showed up for Chromium, the open source foundation of Chrome.

In a statement, here's how Google describes its motives: "Chrome has improved significantly since it was first released

in 2008. We're working on refreshing the icon to better represent the speed and simplicity of the modern browser and operating system."

